

Dino Collalti

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CURRENT POSITION

2023 - now	University of Bern , Post-Doctoral Researcher in Economics at the interdisciplinary Center for Regional Economic Development (CRED)
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EDUCATION

2019 - 2023	University of Bern , PhD in Economics with Graduate School in Climate Science <i>Insigni cum laude</i>
2016 - 2019	University of Bern , MSc in Applied Economic Analysis <i>Insigni cum laude</i>
2013 - 2016	University of Bern , BSc in Economics with Minor in Public Law <i>Magna cum laude</i>

TEACHING AND RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary:	Environmental Economics & Tourism Economics
Secondary:	Natural Hazards, Development, Applied Econometrics

RESEARCH

Work in Progress

- **Tourism and Economic Development: Evidence from Switzerland**, *Dino Collalti*

We study the long-run developmental effects of tourism in Switzerland, an early center of modern tourism. Using a digitized 1867 travel guidebook, we construct municipality-level measures of initial tourism attractiveness and link them to administrative data spanning more than a century. Leveraging these historical measures as instruments, we disentangle the persistent legacy of early tourism from the contemporaneous impact of the sector. Early tourism expansion leaves a sizable positive imprint on present-day employment, population, and wages, with gains largely arising outside the tourism sector. In contrast, conditional on this legacy, further current tourism growth raises tourism employment but crowds out non-tourism jobs, leading to lower overall employment and population. Wage decompositions suggest these effects operate mainly through changes in workforce composition rather than productivity differences across municipalities. Moreover, a greater prevalence of second homes is associated with weaker local labor market performance. Overall, the results indicate strong path dependence: early adoption generates lasting benefits, whereas later tourism-driven development often correlates with adverse outcomes.

Working Papers

- **Flash Flood Hazard: an Economic Analysis of Firms in Central America and the Caribbean**, *Dino Collalti*

This paper investigates the effect of flash floods on establishment performance. To this end, I physically define flash flood occurrences from satellite rainfall data across countries in Central America and the Caribbean and connect them with geo-located establishment survey data. I find that a flash flood significantly decreases sales and the number of employees but increases capital productivity after controlling for the location-specific extreme rainfall history. The negative effects are driven by establishments for which financial market access is an obstacle, whereas the increased capital productivity occurs in establishments that have sufficient financial market access. Improving financial market access appears to be an effective adaptation strategy to increase establishments' resilience.

- **Tourism Demand Spillover: The Case of Hurricane Strikes in The Caribbean**, *Dino Collalti, Monika Bandi & Eric Strobl*

This study investigates the direct effect and spillover of hurricane strikes on tourist arrivals in the Caribbean. We utilize a physically based index of hurricane destruction and develop a measure of indirect hurricane exposure on nearby islands to identify spillovers. After accounting for location, time, and location-specific seasonality variation, we find that hurricanes significantly decrease the number of tourist arrivals in the destinations hit but increase the

number of arrivals on nearby islands. This tourism demand spillover effect is more pronounced in cruise ship arrivals than air arrivals and generally disappears after one year. We hypothesize that cruise ships prospectively change their routes in anticipation of a hurricane strike, resulting in a stronger effect compared to air arrivals.

Publications

- **The Economic Dynamics After a Flood: Evidence from Satellite Data**, *Dino Collalti*. *Environmental and Resource Economics* 87, 2401–2428 (2024). 10.1007/s10640-024-00887-6
This study investigates the effect of flash floods on local economic activity in Central America and the Caribbean. I measure these rarely analyzed floods by constructing a high-resolution, physically based index of flash flood occurrence from satellite data and connect these to changes in local night light emissions. In countries with a low to medium human development index (HDI), the average negative effect can be up to 5.6% in the following months. Countries with higher HDI appear more resilient and are only marginally affected. Due to their high frequency, flash floods have a detrimental effect on local economic growth in developing countries that will likely be exacerbated by climate change.
- **Flash Flood Detection via Copula-based IDF Curves: Evidence from Jamaica**, *Dino Collalti, Nekeisha Spencer & Eric Strobl*. *Natural Hazards and Earth System Sciences* (2024). 10.5194/nhess-2023-162
This study uses the copula method to model the dependence between the intensity and duration of rainfall events separately and flexibly from their respective marginal distribution of extreme rainfall events. It delivers a flexible approach to generating rainfall intensity-duration-frequency curves that can directly be used to assess flash flood risk.
- **Economic damages due to extreme precipitation during tropical storms: evidence from Jamaica**, *Dino Collalti & Eric Strobl*. *Natural Hazards* (2021): 1-28. 10.1007/s11069-021-05025-9
We investigate economic damage risk due to extreme rainfall during tropical storms in Jamaica. We show that variation in maximum rainfall during a storm significantly contributes to parish-level damages even after controlling for local wind speed. For instance, the damage risk for a 20 year rainfall event in Jamaica is estimated to be at least 238 million USD, i.e. about 1.5% of Jamaica's yearly GDP.

ACADEMIC SERVICES

- Referee for
Journal of Economic Growth; Nature Communications; Nature Cities; Environmental and Resource Economics; Environment and Development Economics; Population and Environment; Economics of Disasters and Climate Change; Natural Hazards and Earth System Sciences; Big Earth Data, Competitiveness Review; Zeitschrift für Tourismuswissenschaften.
- Workshops and conferences: Co-organizing the inaugural workshop of *Swiss Early Career Researcher (ERC) Network in Tourism & Hospitality* in Bern 2025.
- Commission and committee work
Representative of PhD student's at the faculty meetings, hiring committee for chair structural economics with a focus on labor economics at the University of Bern, member of the evaluation commission of the Bachelor in Economics and Master of Applied Economic Analysis.
- Other:
 - Student Advisory for the Department of Economics 2019 - 2023
 - Member of the student council both at the faculty and university level

PROJECTS AND OUTREACH

- Co-project lead in the project STEPS Smart Tourism Evaluation, Prediction and Sustainable Development
In this project, we set out to understand how tourism movement and activity patterns can be better managed. These practical findings will be used to provide targeted support for sustainable development in the case study regions.

Here are some of my recent media appearances:

- Die Wirkung von Grossevents am Beispiel der Rad-WM 2024 - Beitrag in *Die Volkswirtschaft* with Monika Bandi, July 2025. <https://dievolkswirtschaft.ch/de/2025/07/die-wirkung-von-grossevents-am-beispiel-der-rad-wm-2024/>
- Contribution to the Swiss Yearbook on Tourism 2024/2025 - *Risiken der Inflationsentwicklung auf die touristische Nachfrage - Rückkehr des Geists vergangener Jahre?* with Monika Bandi and Dominic Beutler, March 2025 <https://www.esv.info/978-3-503-24052-4>
- Wirtschaftsraum Bern Wirtschaftsmonitoring 2024 – *Presentation of the Economic Monitoring 2024*, February 2025. https://www.wirtschaftsraum.bern.ch/de/events/rueckblick/rueckblick_input-events/

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2025	Workshop at Swiss Climate Science Summer School; Introduction to Tourism Economics 1 & II (Bachelor level); Seminar: Empirical Tourism Economics (Master level) University of Bern; Tourism Economics (Bachelor level) at MCI Innsbruck
2024	Introduction to Tourism Economics I & II (Bachelor level); Seminar: Empirical Tourism Economics (Master level), University of Bern; Tourism Economics (Bachelor level) at MCI Innsbruck
2023	Introduction to Tourism Economics I (Bachelor level), University of Bern
2023	Workshop at Swiss Climate Science Summer School, University of Bern
2021/2022/2023	Environmental Econometrics (Master level), University of Bern
2021	Seminar: Economic Analysis of Extreme Climate Events (Master level), University of Bern

PRESENTATIONS

2025	Annual Conference of the European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (Bergen, EAERE), Annual Conference of the International Association of Scientific Experts in Tourism (Paris, AIEST)
2024	Heidelberg Workshop on Labor Economics and Regional Economic Development (Heidelberg, Germany), Tourism Research Center Conference (Istanbul, Turkey)
2023	Heidelberg Workshop on Labor Economics and Regional Economic Development (Heidelberg, Germany), WECON Economics Conference of the West Indies (Kingston, Jamaica)
2022	VI Econometric Models of Climate Change Conference at Toulouse School of Economics, Annual Conference of the European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (Rimini, EAERE), Empirical Microeconomists Lunch Talk, Department of Economics, University of Bern.
2021	Interdisciplinary Ph.D. Workshop in Sustainable Development at Columbia University (IPWSD), Workshop on Compound Weather and Climate Events (Bern/Online, Oeschger Center for Climate Change Research).
2020	Annual Conference of the European Association of Environmental and Resource Economists (Berlin, EAERE), Brown Bag, Department of Economics, University of Bern (2).

WORKSHOPS AND SELECTED COURSEWORK

2023	ICRET Workshop on Multiple Crisis in Tourism (Innsbruck, Austria)
2022	20th Swiss Climate Summer School: Extreme weather and climate: from atmospheric processes to impacts on ecosystems and society (University of Bern, ETH Zurich).
2021	Spatial Methods for Economists using Python (University of Bern).
2020	EAERE European Winter School: Spatial Environmental and Resource Economics (ETH Zurich).

SKILL SET

Programming

R, Python, Matlab, Latex

Languages

German (native), English (fluent), French (B1)

PERSONAL ACTIVITIES

Sport Climbing Judge

National judge of the Swiss Alpine Federation for national and international competitions.